

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 364

By Mitchell

A RESOLUTION to honor TailGate Brewery on the occasion of its tenth anniversary in Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize a local Tennessee business that has grown leaps and bounds to earn distinction as one of the best craft beer breweries in the nation; and

WHEREAS, in February 2025, TailGate Brewery celebrated its tenth anniversary in Nashville, after owner Wes Keegan relocated his company from San Diego, California, in the fall of 2014; and

WHEREAS, the seven-acre TailGate Brewery headquarters opened in West Nashville in February 2015, and the rest, as they say, is history; and

WHEREAS, from the humble beginnings of a one-man operation with no outside investors, TailGate Brewery has grown to include 250 team members and nine breweries in Tennessee, and the original location now features a fifty-barrel brewing system that produces more than 300 recipes per year; and

WHEREAS, the second TailGate location opened on Music Row in 2016, followed by new locations in East Nashville in 2018, Nashville International Airport in 2021, Germantown, Hendersonville, and Chattanooga in 2022, South Nashville in 2023, and Murfreesboro in 2024; and

WHEREAS, these nine breweries have three essential elements in common: cold, creative beer, delicious pizza, and friendly customer service; and

WHEREAS, although he has attained great success in the past ten years, Mr. Keegan remains committed to his mission of owning and operating the best craft beer brewery in Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Keegan's business model centers on people, and he wisely credits his employees as key players in TailGate's growth and overall success; and

WHEREAS, TailGate has been able to hire and retain employees in a tight labor market because of the company's ongoing investment in its team members; and

WHEREAS, in July 2022, TailGate began paying 100 percent of health-care benefits for every one of its employees, thus achieving a longtime goal; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Keegan was inspired to offer this rare industry benefit to his employees by the example of his late father, who died too young, in large part because he did not have access to health care; and

WHEREAS, an icon in Nashville for ten years, TailGate Brewery is deserving of our recognition as a bastion of great beer and even better company; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor owner Wes Keegan and the management and employees of TailGate Brewery on the occasion of the brewery's tenth anniversary in Nashville and congratulate them on growing their business to include nine locations in Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.